

VANDANA RACHERLA

Network Automation and Security Architect | Network Automation & Security Specialist | Cisco DevNet Certified | CISSP Certified

Results-driven Lead Software Engineer with nearly 19 years of expertise in Network Automation, Cybersecurity, and Infrastructure Testing, targeting senior roles in Networking & Security to design scalable automation solutions, strengthen compliance, and enhance network reliability through innovative monitoring and leadership.



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PROFILE SUMMARY

- **CISSP-certified professional** with proven expertise in Cybersecurity, Compliance Automation, and secure Network Operations.
- Skilled in **Python, Ansible, and Ansible Automation Platform** for designing scalable automation solutions that reduce manual effort and improve compliance.
- Proficient in **Cisco routers, switches, firewalls (ASA, FTD, IIoT platforms)**, with deep knowledge of protocols including BGP, OSPF, VRF, and DHCP.
- Strong background in **monitoring and observability** using Grafana, delivering proactive performance analysis, alerting, and root cause resolution.
- Recognized for **cross-functional leadership**, mentoring teams, and driving agile development practices to deliver automation and security solutions aligned with business goals.



ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Monetary Recognition & Team-wide Appreciation** – Wells Fargo | For setting standards in monitoring and alerting of servers and application infrastructure across Secure Network Services.
- **Team Spotlight Award – Sept 2025:** Recognized for RCA on Application Hosting Team access issues.
- **Team Spotlight Award – June 2025:** Automated pre- and post-implementation validations for critical feature releases.
- **Manager Spotlight Award – Feb 2025:** Developed and delivered monitoring and alerting solutions for SNS-Network Automation applications.
- **Q3 GM CAP Support Team Recognition** – Michael Shannon, Cisco (Apr 2021) | *You Amaze 1 Award* for contributions to “Our People Deal.”
- **You Amaze 1 Awards** – Srikanth Raghavan, Cisco (Mar 2021, Nov 2020) | Recognized for outstanding automation efforts and process improvements.
- **You Inspire 3 & You Amaze 2 Awards** – Srikanth Raghavan, Cisco (Jun 2020, Apr 2020) | For excellence in scale automation, automation council initiatives, and team collaboration.
- **Benefit Everyone Awards** – Chin Nguyen & Srikanth Raghavan, Cisco (Sep 2019, Feb 2019) | For teamwork, monitoring, and alerting infrastructure improvements.



CORE COMPETENCIES

- Network Automation & Orchestration
- Cybersecurity & Compliance (CISSP, Security+)
- Ansible Automation Platform (AAP)
- Python, TCL & Perl Scripting
- Cisco Routing, Switching & Firewalls (ASA, FTD)
- Infrastructure Automation & CI/CD Pipelines
- Monitoring & Observability
- Protocol Testing & Validation
- Agile Development & Sprint Planning
- Root Cause Analysis (RCA) & Problem Resolution



TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Networking & Security:** Cisco Routers, Switches, Firewalls (ASA, FTD, IIoT Platforms), VPNs, VRF, BGP, OSPF, DHCP, EIGRP, PBR
- **Automation & Scripting:** Python, Ansible, Ansible Automation Platform (AAP), REST APIs, TCL, Perl, Robot Framework, Cisco DevNet Associate
- **Monitoring & Observability:** Grafana, Logging & Alerting, Performance Benchmarking, SNMP Testing
- **DevOps & CI/CD:** Jenkins, Git, Continuous Integration & Deployment Pipelines
- **Testing Tools & Platforms:** Spirent Test Center, Abacus, Shenick, SmartBits, iRACE, aeTest, autoTest
- **Cybersecurity:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, CEH v11, Red Team Master Certificate
- **Cloud & Virtualization:** Azure Fundamentals, VMware, KVM, Hypervisor-based Test Beds
- **Methodologies:** Agile/Scrum, Sprint Planning, RCA & Defect Management



SOFT SKILLS

- Leadership & Team Mentoring
- Strategic Planning & Decision-Making
- Analytical Thinking & Problem Solving
- Multitasking & Time Management
- Effective Communication
- Adaptability & Working Under Pressure

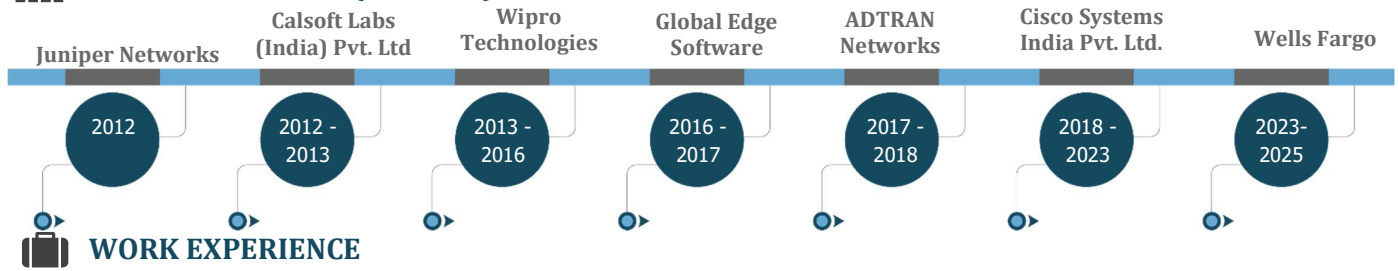


CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) – ISC²
- Cisco DEVNET Associate – Cisco Systems
- Cybersecurity Essentials
- Master Certificate in Cybersecurity – Red Team
- Introduction to Cybersecurity Azure Fundamentals – Microsoft
- Azure Fundamentals



CAREER TIMELINE (Recent 7)



May 2023 – Present | Lead Network Automation Engineer | WELLS FARGO, Hyderabad

Responsibilities:

- Automating data center operations using Ansible and Python to enhance efficiency and reduce manual intervention.
- Developing automation solutions to streamline compliance, security, and operational tasks.
- Launching Python-based Network Devices Health API statistics collection tool into production, including reporting and logging modules.
- Validating pre- and post-configuration states of network devices through automated Ansible workflows before and after change implementation.
- Implementing Grafana monitoring and observability for all Python applications, continuously alerting and tracking anomalous conditions.
- Recognized via cross-functional e-cards for contributions demonstrating:*
 - Collaboration & Due Diligence Performance e-card:** Conducted RCA on Ansible playbook issues affecting log collection during production change requests in collaboration with the BOKS Engineering Team for the SNS Network Reliability Engineering Team. Received e-cards from both a peer and reporting manager.
 - Ownership & Problem Resolution Performance e-card:** Investigated folder access issues in production impacting the Application Hosting Team's Ansible execution, provided a detailed RCA, and recommended preventive measures.
 - Professional Attitude & Automation Expertise Performance e-card:** Recognized by the Zero Trust Segmentation Team for deep understanding of bank processes and for demonstrating strong automation expertise.
 - Invaluable Help Performance e-card:** Received from the US SNS-NetworkAutomation Team for assisting them in onboarding their applications to Grafana.

Oct 2018 – Apr 2023 | Senior Software Engineer – Network Security, Grade 10 | CISCO SYSTEMS INDIA PVT. LTD., Bangalore

Responsibilities:

- Worked on Next-Gen Firewalls including Firepower Threat Defence (FTD) and Adaptive Security Appliance (ASA) across virtual and physical platforms.
- Authored test plans for BGPv6 Graceful Restart and DHCPv6 Prefix Delegation Client features on ASA and FTD (Release 7.3).
- Executed BGPv6 Graceful Restart testing on ASA and automated DHCPv6 Prefix Delegation feature testing for Release 7.3.
- Implemented EIGRPv6 support on ASA for Release 7.4 and ensured feature parity between Next Gen Petra & Trax IIoT platforms and legacy IIoT systems.
- Prepared test plans and conducted feature testing of VRF-lite for IPv4/IPv6 with OSPFv2/OSPFv3 on IIoT platforms (IE3400, IE3300, IE3200, IE3400H, ESS3300), automating 60+ test cases for regression.
- Developed test plans and automated 50+ PBR test cases for IPv4, handing them off to regression.
- Enhanced code coverage through scale automation of multiple protocols on the IE Petra platform.
- Automated newly added platforms in the IIoT portfolio and managed scale automation regression runs for scripts adapted from enterprise-grade platforms.



PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Jul 2017 – Jun 2018 | Senior Staff Engineer – System Team | ADTRAN Networks

Jul 2016 – Jun 2017 | Technical Leader – Testing | Global Edge Software Limited (Microsemi Account)

Jul 2013 – Jul 2016 | Module Leader – Testing | Wipro Technologies (Ericsson Account)

Jul 2012 – Jun 2013 | Module Leader – Testing | Calsoft Labs (India) Pvt. Ltd., Bangalore

Jan 2012 – Jun 2012 | Consultant | Juniper Networks (via IKYA Human Capital Solutions), Bangalore

Mar 2008 – Dec 2009 | Software Engineer II – Automation, Grade 6 | Cisco Systems (India) Pvt. Ltd., Bangalore

Oct 2004 – Feb 2008 | Software Engineer II – Testing | Broadcom Corporation, Hyderabad



EDUCATION



B.Tech. in Electronics & Communication Engineering

Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Hyderabad | 1999 – 2003